NORTHAMPTONSHIRE COUNTY BADMINTON ASSOCIATION

Senior County Championships (SCC)

Player Agreement

This Agreement sets out the standards of conduct, communication, participation and engagement applicable to players seeking selection for the Northamptonshire County Badminton Association ("NCBA") Senior County Championships ("SCC").

This Agreement applies to all players considered for SCC selection.

1. Behaviour and Communication

1.1. The Player is expected to communicate respectfully and appropriately with NCBA Committee members, volunteers, officials, coaches and fellow players.
1.2. The Player is expected to act in accordance with applicable Badminton England Codes of Conduct, policies and guidance.
1.3. Where reasonably possible, the Player should raise questions or concerns through appropriate NCBA channels and avoid seeking to influence matters through informal groups, public forums or indirect means.
1.4. The Player understands that standards of behaviour and communication may form part of the overall assessment for SCC selection.
1.5. The Player is expected to conduct themselves in a manner that supports positive team morale, cooperation and mutual respect.
1.6. The Player should not engage in behaviour that could reasonably be considered bullying, harassment, intimidation or conduct likely to bring NCBA or the sport of badminton into disrepute, including through electronic or social media

2. Governance and Selection

2.1. The Player acknowledges that SCC selection is overseen by the NCBA Committee in accordance with NCBA rules, including Rule 11.
2.2. Selection decisions are made collectively by the NCBA Committee.
2.3. Previous selection, seniority, length of involvement or past results do not guarantee SCC selection.
2.4. Performance in the County Restricted tournament may be considered as part of the SCC selection process and does not in itself guarantee selection.
2.5. Selection decisions are final.
For clarity, a Player may request clarification of the selection process and the general factors considered. Such clarification is intended to support understanding and does not constitute an appeal or challenge to the selection decision.

3. Confidentiality and Data Protection

3.1. Players are expected to respect confidentiality in relation to NCBA discussions, selection processes, internal communications and personal information.
3.2. Players should act responsibly in relation to privacy and personal data and should not share personal or confidential information (including contact details, medical information or internal communications) obtained through the County environment without appropriate authorisation.
3.3. Players are expected to observe basic data protection principles, including respect for the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), where relevant.
3.4. Players may be asked to complete basic data protection or GDPR awareness training where appropriate.
3.5. Nothing in this Agreement is intended to prevent or restrict a Player from raising safeguarding, welfare, integrity or misconduct concerns through appropriate channels, including Badminton England safeguarding or disciplinary processes where applicable.

4. Participation, Availability and Engagement

4.1. Players are normally expected to attend at least one NCBA county training session during the SCC selection period, unless excused for valid reasons communicated in advance.

4.2. Players are normally expected to enter the County Restricted tournament unless unable to do so for an agreed reason.
4.3. Players are expected to respond in a timely and appropriate manner to SCC availability requests and official communications.

5. **Team Culture, Representation and Third Parties**
5.1. Players are expected to adopt a team-first approach and act in the best interests of the County squad.
5.2. Players are expected to treat all volunteers, officials, coaches and fellow players with respect.
5.3. Players should not encourage or permit any third party (including family members or associates) to harass, intimidate or improperly influence volunteers, officials or the SCC selection process.
5.4. This does not prevent appropriate support being provided to a junior player by a parent or guardian through agreed and appropriate channels, nor does it prevent the raising of safeguarding or welfare concerns.
5.5. Questions or concerns should be raised directly, respectfully and through appropriate NCBA channels.
5.6. Players are expected to represent the NCBA with professionalism both on and off the court.

6. **Selection Consideration**
6.1. Meeting the expectations set out in this Agreement enables consideration for SCC selection but does not guarantee selection.
6.2. Selection decisions may consider a range of factors, including:
6.2.1. current performance and form.
6.2.2. availability and commitment.
6.2.3. team balance and overall squad needs.
6.2.4. conduct, communication and engagement.
6.3. Failure to meet these expectations may be considered when considering SCC selection.
6.4. This Agreement operates alongside, and does not replace, Badminton England disciplinary, safeguarding or integrity processes, which apply separately where relevant.

7. Player Declaration

By signing below, the Player confirms that they have read and understood this Agreement and agrees to uphold the expectations set out above.

Player Name: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____